On Paper, in Someone's Head, or Not Sure?

A quick check of what your family has written down about Mom's care costs and money decisions. Thirteen questions; at the end: what's on paper, what isn't yet, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks what your family has written down. It doesn't measure Mom's finances, and a no or a not sure only means there is something still to write down or ask.

1. Have you written down what Mom's care costs each month, from the latest bill?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Have you written down what comes in for Mom each month?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which accounts the rest of her care bill is paid from?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Have you listed her outstanding debts and regular expenses?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Have you found her insurance policies, any annuity contract and her retirement account statements?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know whether a burial or funeral arrangement has been made, and where its paperwork is?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have you noted whether Mom has a spouse at home whose housing, income and savings belong in the picture?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you listed any gifts, repayments, transfers, sales or account changes already made, with dates?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you written down the money decisions the family is talking about?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down what people have told you about what has to be spent or moved, and who said each thing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Are the statements, receipts and contracts for Mom's care in one place?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Have you written down your questions for a professional?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

13. For each question, do you know which kind of professional it goes to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT'S ON PAPER

WHAT ISN'T ON PAPER YET

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what your family has written down, not how Mom's finances stand or what may happen with Medicaid. A low count means there are things still to write down, and many of them are a statement, a phone call or a relative away. It doesn't say what has to be spent, how any asset is treated, or what anything your family has done or is considering may mean. Rules vary by state, nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice, and those questions go to your Medicaid planner.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what's on paper and what isn't yet. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›